

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 3
 ♥ 9 8 6 4 3
 ♦ Q 10
 ♣ J 5 4 2

♠ A J 10

♥ Q 10 7

♦ K J 6

♣ A K 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 8 5

♥ A 2

♦ 9 7 5 4 2

♣ Q 9

♠ Q 7 4 2

♥ K J 5

♦ A 8 3

♣ 10 7 6

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♦ 7			

You dealt this hand.

This would be an ideal hand to open 1NT - well, it would be with one less point. But with 18 you are too strong to open 1NT so you open 1 ♣. Partner responds 1 ♠.

DO NOT fall into the trap of supporting partner's ♠s just because you have such nice help for him. He might have a 4-card suit. Instead, just describe your hand by jumping to 2NT, showing a balanced hand with 18-19 points. Partner now bids 3NT and you play it there.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 6
♥ A K 7
♦ Q 8 6 4
♣ A K 8

♠ 5 3

♥ 10 6 3 2

♦ J 10 9 5

♣ Q J 2



♠ K 10 9 7 4 2

♥ Q J 5

♦ 3

♣ 7 4 3

♠ A 8

♥ 9 8 4

♦ A K 7 2

♣ 10 9 6 5

West

1 ♦

2NT

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♦ K

North

Pass

Pass

East

1 ♠

3 ♠

South

Pass

Pass

You dealt this hand.

You open 1 ♦ and partner responds 1 ♠. What is your next bid?

Do not support what may be a 4-card suit with only 3 cards. Instead, jump to 2NT, showing 18-19, balanced. Partner rebids the ♠s. What do you say next?

Partner shows a minimum hand, but with 6 ♠s. 3NT is very tempting, and might work out fine, but with 9 ♠s it is probably better to play the suit game. So you bid 4 ♠ and everybody passes.

Bidding 4 ♠ was a good choice. It makes easily, yet 3NT might have gone down.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 2
 ♥ 10 7 4
 ♦ A Q 10 6 3
 ♣ Q 10

♠ A K 7 4
 ♥ K Q 9 6
 ♦ J 8
 ♣ 9 7 6



♠ Q 3
 ♥ A J 3 2
 ♦ K 9 5
 ♣ J 5 4 2

♠ J 10 9 6
 ♥ 8 5
 ♦ 7 4 2
 ♣ A K 8 3

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠		
All Pass			
2 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♠ 2			

You have plenty good support to raise partner's ♣ suit. But your first priority is to show a 4-card Major suit if you have one. You do, so you respond 1 ♠. Partner raises you to 2 ♠.

Are you tempted to take partner back to ♣s since you have such good support? Don't be. Partner has 4 ♠s, but he might have only 3 ♣s.

Are you tempted to bid 3 ♠ since partner raised you? Don't be. He showed a minimum hand with his single raise and you only have 9 points. Just pass.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 7 6
 ♥ A J 9 6
 ♦ A K 8 3
 ♣ J 8 5

♠ Q J 8 5

♥ 7

♦ J 6 5

♣ K Q 9 7 4



♠ A K 9

♥ K Q 8 3

♦ Q 10 4 2

♣ 10 3

♠ 10 4 3 2

♥ 10 5 4 2

♦ 9 7

♣ A 6 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

4 ♥

Pass

2 ♥

Pass

All Pass

4 ♥ by West

Lead: ♣K

Some might jump to 2NT, "to show partner my point count". Some might jump to 3 ♦, "to force partner to game and show my ♦ support". The wise ones will just bid 1 ♥, striving to find an 8-card Major fit, the first priority of bidding.

You choose the 1 ♥ route, and partner obligingly says 2 ♥.

Remember "She who knows, goes"? You know of the 8-card Major fit. You know of at least 26 combined points. You know you should bid 4 ♥, so you do.